

General Knowledge

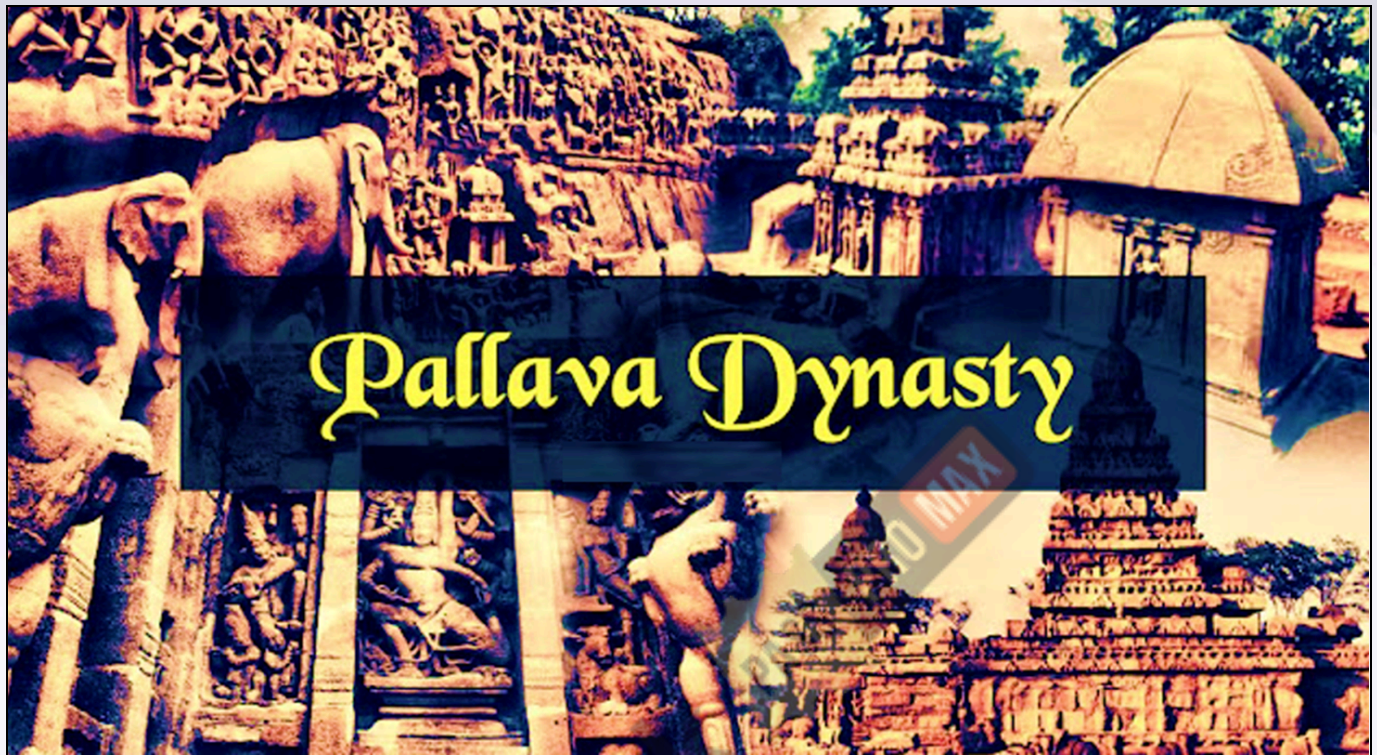
Ancient History

STUDY NOTES

Pallavas And Chalukyas



Post Gupta - Pallavas and Chalukyas



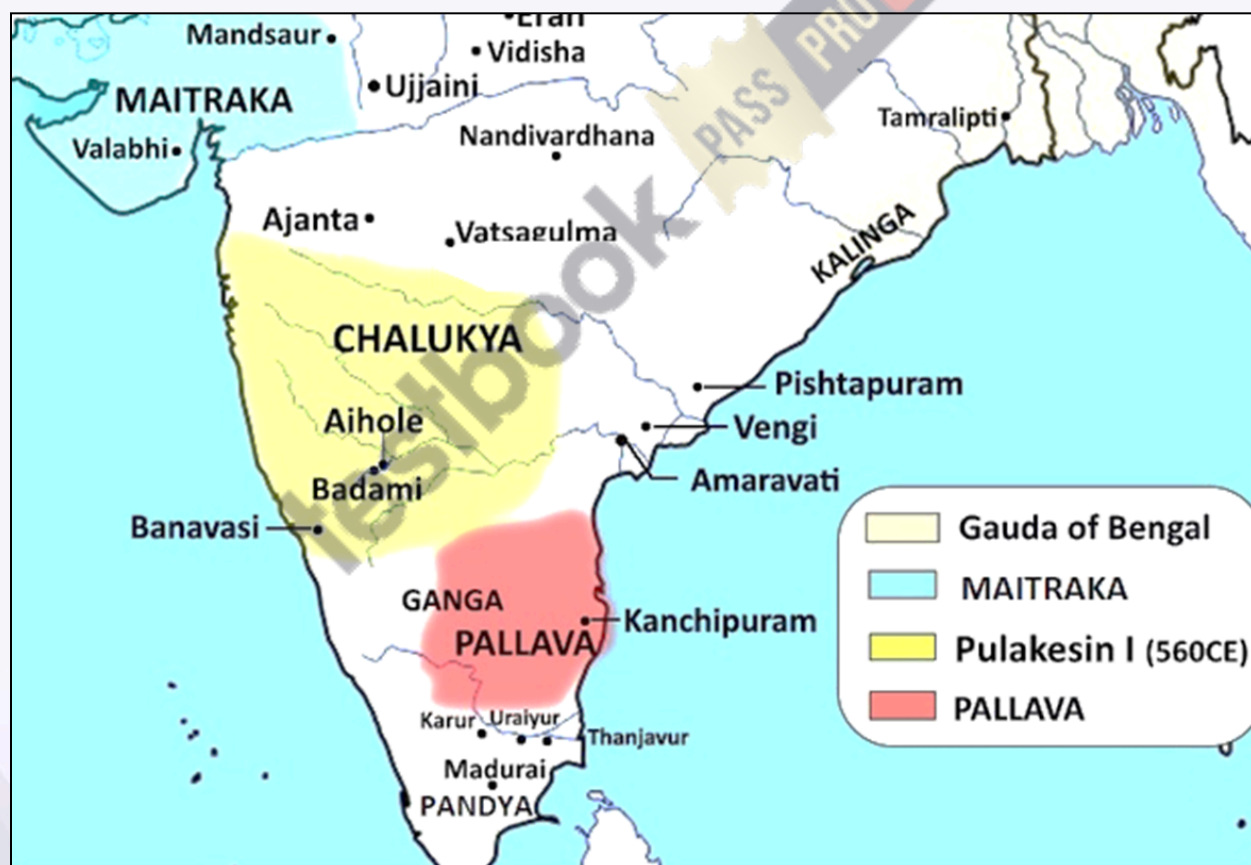
Emergence of the Pallavas of Kanchi

- The Pallavas rose to prominence after **Simhavishnu** defeated the **Kalabhras**, initiating the rule of imperial Pallavas.
- Their core region covered **south Andhra Pradesh** and **north Tamil Nadu**, with **Kanchipuram** (Kanchi) as the capital.
- Throughout their reign, they fought with the **Chalukyas of Vatapi** in the north and the **Cholas** and **Pandys** in the south.
- **Kanchi** flourished under their rule, becoming an important **temple town** and a hub of **trade and commerce**.

Rulers and Contributions of the Pallavas

Ruler	Period of Reign	Key Contributions
Simhavishnu	575-590 CE	- Defeated the Kalabhras and established the Pallava dynasty. - Took titles like Avanisimha (Lion of Earth). - Patronized the poet Bharavi, who authored <i>Kirat Arjuneeya</i>.
Mahendravarman I	600-630 CE	- Expanded Pallava power significantly. - Took artistic titles like Mattavilasa (Addicted to Pleasure) and Chitrakarapuli (Tiger among painters). - Introduced Mahendra Style rock-cut architecture. - Authored the Mattavilasa Prahasana, a Sanskrit satire. - Killed by Pulakesin II of the Chalukyas in the Battle of Pullalur.
Narasimhavarman I (Mamalla)	630-668 CE	- Known as the greatest Pallava king. Took the title Vatapikonda (Conqueror of Vatapi). - Defeated Pulakesin II, king of the Chalukyas, and destroyed Vatapi. - Founded Mahabalipuram and initiated the construction of Seven Rathas. - Invaded Sri Lanka twice, helping Manavamma, a prince in exile. - Hosted the Chinese traveller Hsuen Tsang at Kanchipuram in 642 CE.

Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha)	695–722 CE	- Reign marked by peace and cessation of conflicts with the Chalukyas. - Constructed the Shore Temple and Kailashnath Temple at Kanchipuram. - Sent embassies to China to strengthen foreign relations.
Nandivarman II	736–796 CE	- Built the Vaikunth Perumal Temple, dedicated to Vishnu. - Promoted the Bhakti Movement through temple activities. - Strengthened village autonomy.



Art and Architecture under the Pallavas

Architectural Style	Features	Examples
Mahendra Style 	- Introduced rock-cut temples. No use of bricks or wood. Mandapas were pillared verandas with Garbhagriha.	Mamandur Monuments, Trimurti Mandapa, Mahendravisnu Mandapa.
Mamalla Style 	- Built Rathas (monolithic chariots) alongside mandapas. - Lion-headed pillars used for decoration.	Seven Rathas, Varaha Mandapa, Mahisasura Mandapa.
Rajasimha Style 	- Temples became more elaborate with intricate carvings. - Use of stone, wood, and bricks.	Shore Temple, Kailashnath Temple, Mukunda Temple.
Nandivarman Style 	Temples were smaller, less decorative, and reflected a decline in Pallava architecture.	Mukteshwar Temple, Matangeshwar Temple.

Major Pallava Temples and Structures

Temple/Structure	Description
Shore Temple 	- Constructed by Narasimhavarman II at Mahabalipuram. - Consists of three shrines dedicated to Shiva and Vishnu. - Declared a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
Kailashnath Temple 	- Built by Narasimhavarman II at Kanchipuram. - Features 16-sided Shivalinga in the main shrine. - Notable for 58 mini-shrines (devakulikas) surrounding the temple.
Seven Rathas 	- Initiated by Narasimhavarman I to represent early monolithic architecture. - Key rathas include Draupadi Ratha, Dharmaraja Ratha, and Bhim Ratha.
Vaikunth Perumal Temple	- Constructed by Nandivarman II. - Dedicated to Vishnu, showcasing his three forms (standing, sitting, reclining). - Contains inscriptions depicting Nandivarman's ascent to power.



Administration under the Pallavas

Aspect	Details
Form of Government	Monarchy; Pallava kings assumed titles like Dharma-Maharaja .
Administrative Divisions	The empire was divided into Kottams , governed by officers appointed by the king.
Village Administration	Villages were self-governing republics managed by local assemblies like Sabha and Urar .
Judiciary	Each village had a court known as Dharmasasana to administer justice.

Economy under the Pallavas

Aspect	Details
Primary Source of Income	Land revenue was the main source.
Taxes	Taxes were imposed on professions, marriages, salt, textiles, and cattle .
Agriculture	Agriculture was prosperous, with laborers paid in kind . Hsuen Tsang noted the region's fertile land.

Land Grants	Brahmadeya villages (tax-free lands) were given to Brahmins, promoting education and religion.
Trade and Commerce	A barter system was prevalent initially, but Pallavas later introduced gold and silver coins to boost trade.
Manigramam	Merchants organized into guilds called Manigramam , promoting commercial activities.
Tank Lands (Eripatti)	Lands whose revenue was dedicated to the maintenance of village tanks .

Society and Religion under the Pallavas

Aspect	Details
Religion	Pallava kings supported Saivism and Vaishnavism . Buddhism and Jainism gradually declined.
Bhakti Movement	Saints like Alvars and Nayanars spread Bhakti traditions, enriching Tamil literature.
Adi Shankaracharya	Reinforced Advaita philosophy , further diminishing Buddhist and Jain influence.
Social Structure	Villages functioned as self-sufficient republics with diverse professional communities.

Arts and Literature under the Pallavas

Aspect	Details
Sanskrit Literature	Pallava kings patronized Sanskrit scholars. Mahendravarman I authored <i>Mattavilasa Prahasana</i> .
Bhakti Literature	Saints composed devotional hymns in Tamil. Key works include Nalariya Divya Prabandham and Tirumurai .

Music and Dance	Pallava kings promoted music and dance. Instruments included Yaazhi , Mridhangam , and Murasu .
Painting	Frescoes at Chittannavasal depict Pallava painting styles.

Decline of the Pallavas

- **Continuous Conflicts:** The Pallavas were engaged in **frequent wars with the Chalukyas** of Vatapi and **Pandyas** of Madurai.
 - These conflicts weakened the Pallava military strength and drained their resources.
- **Plunder of Kanchipuram:** The **Chalukyan army** invaded and **plundered Kanchipuram**, the capital of the Pallavas.
- **Defeat by the Cholas:** **Aparajitavarman**, the last Pallava king, was defeated by the **Chola king Aditya I** in the late 9th century CE.
 - This marked the **end of the Pallava dynasty** and the **rise of Chola dominance** in the region.
- After the defeat of the Pallavas, the Cholas **emerged as the dominant power** in South India, ushering in a new era of regional politics and cultural development.